

INF 132 - MILESTONE 4

RoomieTask

Chores - Expenses - Supplies - Reminders



INTRO

Fun Facts: We are ...



Wendy Wu

Software Engineering + Business
Administration

"I am a FPS game lover, I used to spend 8 hours
per day on the game during the summer"



Ivy Lee

Informatics

"I go to a new coffee shop nearly
every single day."



Myint Ohnmar Kyaw

Informatics + Business Information
Management

"I switch between three languages
almost every day."



Shawn Fishkov

Software Engineering

"I have visited 6 countries
and 6 US states"



Gray Wong

GDIM + Informatics

"I founded a collegiate a
cappella club at UCI!"



Tiffany Dip

Business Administration

"I recently started making
sourdough bread."

The Story

Meet Jamie



Demographic

21 • College Student
Lives with 3 roommates

Conflict Avoidance:
★★★★★

“We all want a clean apartment, but nobody knows who's responsible for what.”

BACKGROUND

Jamie is a busy college student who lives with roommates and tries to keep the apartment clean. Most coordination happens through group chats, but reminders get buried, tasks are forgotten, and Jamie often ends up doing extra work to avoid conflict.

GOAL

- Keep the apartment clean without constantly reminding roommates.
- Make responsibilities clear so everyone contributes fairly.
- Split household expenses transparently and avoid confusion.
- Reduce roommate tension and avoid unnecessary conflict.

PAINPOINTS

- Important chore reminders get buried in busy group chats.
- Never knows whether a task was completed until it becomes a problem.
- Ends up taking on extra chores because others forget or ignore them.
- Repeated conversations about chores create frustration.

THE STORY

After a long day, the kitchen is a mess, again.

Jamie gets home from class drained, hoping to just make food and lie down. Instead, the dishwasher is overflowing with old, dirty dishes. So Jamie texts the group chat.

Jamie

hey, did anyone do the dishes today? the sink's overflowing

Charlie

I'll do them later, I'm busy right now

THE STORY - THE SAME FIGHT

Jamie

but you were supposed to do them earlier today

Charlie

I did them last time! why don't you just do them then?

Charlie didn't do them last time.

Or the several times before.

There's always a reason and the conversation ends with Jamie quietly cleaning up, again.

WHAT ROOMMATES ACTUALLY TOLD US

"It's not even about the chores anymore. I'm just tired of it."

Behind every messy sink is a roommate
who's done asking



The Problem Statement

As a person living with roommates, **when** household responsibilities pile up, **it is** frustrating to stay on top of chores, expenses, and shared supplies because there is no central place to coordinate and communication gets lost in group chats.





The Research

A survey of 44 roommates and 5 usability sessions
& **ONE** finding we didn't expect.

THE FINDING WE DIDN'T EXPECT

Conflict isn't exploding it's being **absorbed**. The frustration is real, but it stays invisible to the very people causing it.



75% said they'd just do the task themselves rather than bring it up



64% named **cleaning & chores** as their #1 source of friction

COMPETITIVE ANALYSIS

Everyone had already tried to fix it themselves



Group chats

"Whose turn is it?" scrolls away by lunch. Nothing is actually tracked.



Flatastic

Household management tools. Completed chores are not clearly reflected on the main dashboard.



Splitwise

Handles money, but not chores, supplies, or whose turn it is.



Whiteboards

Easy to write, easy to ignore and no reminders when it's missed.

WHAT THIS TOLD US TO BUILD

Roommates don't want a manager. They want things to feel fair.

WE FOUND

People silently "do it themselves"
so the work stays invisible.



SO ROOMIETASK

Makes every contribution visible, so no one keeps score alone.

WE FOUND

Group chats and whiteboards get ignored
"in one ear, out the other."



SO ROOMIETASK

Sends gentle nudges and flags overdue tasks until they're done.

WE FOUND

Confrontation feels awkward, so tension builds quietly.



SO ROOMIETASK

Shows fairness gently; never to rank or call anyone out.

USABILITY TESTING

We tested with 5 roommates and listened

INSIGHT 1

Right action, no confirmation

4/5 completed tasks but doubted themselves - "Did I do it?" One gave up entirely, sure it had failed.

Fix: success states, updated task states, and clear active / submitted field states.

INSIGHT 2

Habits from other apps

Users expected Todoist-style patterns - which fields are required, the ability to edit a chore after creating it.

Fix: mark required fields, add edit for chores & expenses, standardize inputs.

INSIGHT 3

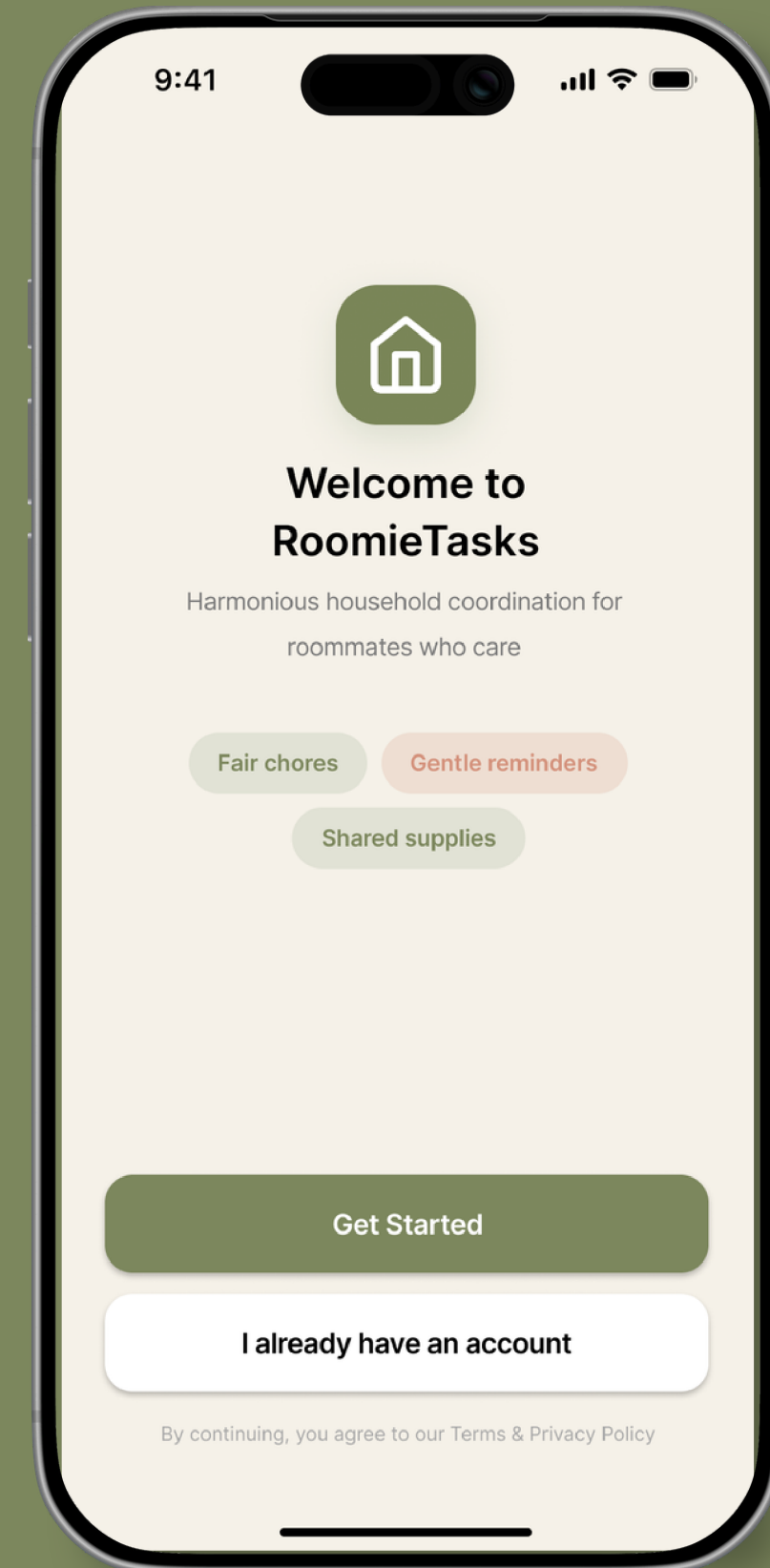
Read by weight, not labels

Users went where the screen looked important - missing the balance, overlooking low-contrast cards.

Fix: balance above transactions, stronger card contrast, one consistent + button.

The Solution

One calm place for chores, money, and supplies.
Let's walk through it.



TAKEAWAYS

What this quarter left with each of us

I

Ivy Lee

Research defines the problem worth solving, and that's more valuable than any pixel-perfect interface.

S

Shawn Fishkov

Even in a seemingly over-saturated market, when the problem persists, a new solution can be found and implemented

G

Gray Wong

There is a strong market gap for an all-in-one roommate coordination tool focused on fairness and ease of use.

T

Tiffany Dip

Full completion is not possible, since there are always new perspectives and possibilities to consider in design.

W

Wendy Wu

A designer thinking mindset is not to jump directly to the solution, but first understand and examine the underlying problem.

M

Myint Ohnmar Kyaw

A great design is built on empathy, observation, and a deep understanding of user needs.

Thank you!

The calm, central home base for everything roommates share.

